VendorHub

Feature & Flow Documentation

A complete, role-by-role walkthrough of every feature currently implemented in the VendorHub marketplace platform — written for testers and anyone reviewing project progress. It covers what a **Customer**, **Vendor**, and **Admin** can each do, exactly how the payment and subscription system works, and an honest list of what is intentionally not yet wired up.

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Scope: Customer app · Vendor dashboard · Admin panel · Payments & Plans

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1. How VendorHub Works — Roles & Accounts

VendorHub has three account types, each with a separate dashboard. Signing in as any of them goes through the same login form — the platform detects which type of account the email belongs to automatically.

Customer

- Signs up with name, email and password. Account is active immediately — no approval step, no email verification.
- Browses vendors, requests quotes, chats with vendors, favorites vendors, and leaves reviews after a completed job.

Vendor

- Signs up with business name, email, password, phone and city.
- Goes live **immediately** by default (the admin can flip a setting to require manual approval first — see §15). While pending approval, the vendor can log in and set up their dashboard, but is not visible to the public yet.
- Gets their own storefront, catalogue manager, quotes inbox, chat inbox, billing page, and (currently hidden, see §13) an analytics page.

Admin

- Not self-service — created directly in the system. One admin account exists today.
- Full control over vendors, users, plans, pricing, coupons, categories, reviews, disputes and every platform-wide setting.

Every server-side action that changes an account is resolved from the signed-in user's own login token, never from data the browser sends — so, for example, a vendor can only ever edit their own profile, not someone else's, even if the request is tampered with.

2. Customer Journey

End to end, in the order a customer actually experiences it.

Browse & Search

- The **Explore** page lists every active vendor with a search box, a city/location filter, a category dropdown, and sorting (Recommended / Highest Rated / Most Reviewed).
- On first visit, the browser may ask for location permission — if granted, vendors in the customer's own city are nudged to the top of the list (a soft boost, not a hard filter).

Vendor Profile

- Shows the vendor's logo/banner, business info, rating, and a **Featured** badge if their plan includes it.
- Three tabs: **Catalogues** (their listed services/products), **Gallery** (up to 5 photos), and **Reviews**.
- Action buttons: **Get Quote** (always available), plus WhatsApp / Call / a custom link if the vendor's plan and settings include them.
- A **Favorite** (heart) button — requires being logged in as a customer.

Requesting a Quote

- Opens a dialog to describe the project (service needed, description, budget, preferred date) — either generically or scoped to a specific catalogue item.
- Submitting it instantly opens a chat thread with that vendor, with the request itself shown as the first message card in the chat.
- The customer can track every quote's status on their own **Quotes** dashboard page.

Once the Vendor Delivers

- When a vendor marks the work **Delivered**, the customer gets two choices: **Confirm Completion** (marks the job done and unlocks the ability to review it), or **Dispute** it with a reason of at least 10 characters, which sends it to the admin team to review.
- If the customer does nothing for 7 days (admin-configurable), the platform automatically marks it Completed on their behalf, so a quote can never get permanently stuck.

Reviews

- A review can only be written for a job that reached **Completed** — never for one still in progress, and a customer can't review the same job twice. They *can* review the same vendor again after a separate, later completed job.
- A review is a star rating (1–5) plus a written comment (10–2000 characters).

Favorites & Inbox

- The **Favorites** page lists every vendor the customer has saved, with quick access to view their profile or request a quote.
- The **Inbox** shows every conversation, with unread counts, read receipts, and live vendor online/offline status.

3. Vendor Journey — Onboarding & Storefront

Signing Up

- A vendor provides business name, email, password, phone and city, and lands on the default (Free) plan automatically — no payment needed to get started.
- If admin approval is required (see §15), the vendor sees an "account under review" state and every admin is notified there's a new vendor to review.

Setting Up the Storefront

Everything below is edited from the Vendor Dashboard → Storefront page and shown live on the vendor's public profile:

- Logo and banner image upload.
- Business name, short description, long description, years in business.
- Contact details: phone, email, address, city, state, ZIP.
- **Extra contact buttons** — WhatsApp number, call number, and a custom button (label + link) — only available on plans that include this feature.
- A free-text list of services offered.
- A photo gallery (up to 5 images).

Managing Quotes & Reviews

Covered in full in §5 (Quote Requests) and §7 (Reviews) — the same lifecycle, from the vendor's side of the desk.

Billing

The vendor's Billing page shows their current plan, usage against every limit, upgrade options, and full payment history. Full detail in §9–§11.

4. Catalogues & Listings

A vendor organizes their work into **Catalogues** (e.g. "Living Room Designs"), each holding one or more **Items** — an individual service or product.

What an item can include

- Title, description, item type (service or product), a cover image, and up to several gallery images (the exact number allowed is controlled by the vendor's plan).
- A starting price and/or a free-text price range.
- **Service items:** materials used, an expected project timeline.
- **Product items:** stock status (in stock / out of stock / made to order) and stock quantity — tracked manually by the vendor, not auto-adjusted by orders.
- **Premium-tier features:** before/after image pairs, a video, and a downloadable PDF brochure.

Plan limits

Every number and every feature toggle above — how many catalogues, how many items per catalogue, how many images per item, which of the Premium-only fields are unlocked — is set by the admin per plan (see §9). If a vendor's plan changes, their existing content is never deleted: anything over the new limit is simply hidden from public view until they upgrade again, then it reappears exactly as it was.

5. Quote Requests — Full Lifecycle

This is the core transaction of the marketplace — a customer asking a vendor to do work, and the two of them taking it from request to completion.

Status	What it means	Who acts next, and how
New	Customer just submitted the request.	Vendor: Respond with a price & timeline, or Decline.
Quoted	Vendor has sent a price and estimated time.	Vendor: Accept (skip ahead) or Decline. Customer sees the quote in chat.
Accepted	Both sides have agreed to proceed.	Vendor: Mark as Delivered once the work is done.
Delivered	Vendor says the work is complete.	Customer: Confirm Completion, or Dispute with a reason.
Disputed	Customer flagged a problem with the delivery.	Admin: side with the vendor (marks Completed) or Reopen it for the vendor to redo.
Completed	Job is done — this is what unlocks a review.	Nothing further — this is the end state.
Rejected	Vendor declined the request.	End state.

Auto-complete safety net: if a customer never responds to a Delivered job, it automatically becomes Completed after a set number of days (default 7, admin-adjustable 1–90 in Settings) — so a quote can never sit stuck forever. Disputing before that window closes takes it out of the auto-complete path entirely.

Every quote request instantly opens a chat thread between the customer and vendor, with the request details posted as the first message. When the vendor responds with a price, that response is posted as a second message card in the same thread — the whole negotiation lives in one place.

6. Messaging & Real-Time Chat

- Real-time chat between any customer and vendor, delivered instantly (no refresh needed) over a live connection.
- Supports text, images, videos, and PDF attachments, with server-enforced size limits (10MB images, 100MB video, 20MB PDF).
- Read receipts and per-conversation unread counts, plus a total unread badge on the Inbox nav item.
- Live presence — shows whether the other person is online right now, or when they were last seen.
- A vendor can start a fresh conversation directly with a specific customer (not just reply to an existing one) — this is exactly what happens when a vendor clicks a "new favorite" notification (see §12).

7. Reviews & Ratings

Customer side

- Can only be written after a quote reaches **Completed** — the app checks this server-side, not just in the UI.
- Star rating (1–5) + a written comment (10–2000 characters).
- A vendor's public rating is the live average of every non-flagged review — it updates immediately when a new review is posted.

Vendor side

- Can flag a review left on their own profile with a reason (fake, offensive, spam, competitor, other) and details — this sends it to the admin queue and excludes it from the vendor's rating average while it's under review. The review stays visible; it just stops counting toward the score until resolved.

Admin side

- Sees every review platform-wide (not just flagged ones), can delete any review outright, or dismiss a flag and restore the review to the vendor's average.
- Both the vendor and the reviewing customer are notified of the outcome either way.

8. Notifications — Every Type, What Triggers It

Every notification appears instantly in the bell icon (live, no refresh) and is also stored so it's still there next time the user logs in.

Type	Fires when…	Goes to
Account	Vendor signup needs approval; admin approves / rejects / suspends / reinstates a vendor; admin bans/unbans a customer.	Vendor / Customer
Subscription	Plan changes, a payment succeeds or fails, a plan expires, or an expiry reminder is due.	Vendor
Favorite	A customer favorites a Premium vendor's profile.	Vendor
Message	A new chat message arrives.	Whichever side didn't send it
Quote	A quote is created, responded to, accepted/declined, delivered, or completed.	Vendor / Customer
Quote Dispute	A customer disputes a delivered job.	All admins
Review	A new review is posted, or a customer's review is removed by an admin.	Vendor / Customer
Review Flag	A vendor flags a review; an admin resolves a flag.	Admins / Vendor
Vendor (new)	A new vendor signs up and needs approval.	All admins

9. Plans & Subscriptions

*The guiding rule behind this whole system: **nothing about a plan is hardcoded.** Every price, every limit, and every feature toggle for Free, Basic, and Premium is a setting the admin controls from the Plans page — change it there and it applies to every vendor on that plan immediately, no app update needed.*

Feature	Free	Basic	Premium
Monthly price	Rs. 0	Rs. 199*	Rs. 299*
Catalogues	1	5	7
Items per catalogue	2	5	10
Images per item	1	3	7
Description length	Short	Medium	Long
Price range display	—	—	✓
Materials & timeline details	—	—	✓
Before / after images	—	—	✓
Video & PDF brochure	—	—	✓
Featured badge & priority listing	—	—	✓
Extra contact buttons (WhatsApp/Call/Custom)	—	—	✓
Analytics: profile views + quote trend	—	✓	✓
Analytics: full charts, conversion rate, favorites feed & notifications	—	—	✓

** Current values — every number above is admin-editable at any time.*

How a subscription behaves over time

- **Upgrading is immediate.** The moment payment succeeds, the vendor's new limits and features are live — no waiting.
- **Upgrading credits unused time.** If a vendor upgrades mid-cycle, whatever they already paid for the remaining days of their current plan is automatically deducted from the new plan's price at checkout.
- **No downgrades while a plan is active.** A vendor on Premium cannot switch to Basic mid-cycle. Once their current plan naturally expires, they're free to choose any plan again, including a cheaper one.
- **No auto-renewal.** Every plan is a fixed term. There is no automatic recurring charge — the vendor must actively buy again to continue on a paid tier. The admin sets how many days before expiry a reminder notification is sent (default: 7, 3, and 1 days before), fully configurable in Settings.
- **If a paid plan lapses,** the vendor automatically falls back to the Free plan — their content isn't deleted, just hidden where it exceeds the Free plan's limits.
- **No refunds.** Once a vendor pays, that charge is final. If an admin needs to revoke access early (fraud, a mistake, a policy issue), they can force-end a subscription immediately from the admin panel — but no money is ever returned automatically.

10. Payments & Checkout

Payments currently run through a fully simulated gateway — built so the entire real checkout flow (order creation, signature verification, success/failure/pending handling) works exactly like a live payment provider, just without needing a real merchant account yet. Swapping in a real gateway later is a backend-only change; nothing about the checkout screens changes.

Checkout flow

- Vendor picks a plan on the Pricing or Billing page → a checkout dialog opens showing the exact amount due (already accounting for any upgrade credit).
- An optional **coupon code** field applies a discount before payment — see §11.
- Vendor enters a test card number and pays.
- On success, the plan activates immediately and a receipt appears in Billing → Payment History.

Test cards (see §16 for the full cheat sheet)

- A card ending in `1111` always succeeds.
- A card ending in `0002` is always declined.
- A card ending in `0119` is pending, then settles successfully on a second check.

Server-side price authority

The amount charged is always looked up from the Plan record on the server at the moment of checkout — the app never trusts a price value sent from the browser, so it's impossible to tamper with an amount from the client side.

11. Coupons

Admin side

- Create a coupon with a code, and either a percentage-off or a flat-amount-off discount.
- Optionally restrict it to specific plans, give it an expiry date, cap how many times it can be redeemed in total, and toggle it active/inactive at any time.
- A coupon that's already been used by someone can be deactivated but not deleted (its history is preserved); an unused coupon can be deleted outright.

Vendor side

- Enter a code at checkout to see the discount applied before paying.
- An invalid, expired, inactive, plan-restricted (wrong plan), or fully-redeemed coupon is rejected with a clear reason.
- If a coupon (combined with any upgrade credit) covers the full price, the plan activates instantly with no card needed at all.

12. Favorites & Direct-Message-the-Customer Flow

Favorites are saved on the server against the customer's account (not just in their browser), so the list is the same on every device they log in from.

- A customer taps the heart icon on any vendor's profile to save/unsave it.
- Every favorite counts toward that vendor's favorites total — visible to all vendors once they reach Premium.
- **If the vendor is on Premium,** the moment a customer favorites them, they get an instant notification naming that customer.
- **Clicking that notification takes the vendor straight into a live chat with that exact customer** — it opens their existing conversation if one exists, or starts a brand-new one if they've never spoken before. The vendor can reply immediately, no extra steps.
- Free and Basic vendors still receive and keep every favorite (it's not lost), they just aren't notified about it in real time.

13. Vendor Analytics (built, temporarily hidden)

*A full analytics page for vendors has been built and is fully working end-to-end, but it is currently **hidden from the vendor dashboard menu** at your request, to be switched back on later. It is not something to test right now — noted here purely so it's clear this is a deliberate, reversible decision and not missing/broken work.*

What it will show once re-enabled:

- **Free:** total quotes, total reviews, average rating.
- **Basic adds:** a profile views counter and a quote-requests trend chart.
- **Premium adds:** a profile-views trend chart, a rating trend chart, a views-to-quotes conversion rate, and a feed of everyone who's recently favorited them.
- A vendor below the tier a chart requires sees it as a blurred preview with an "Upgrade to unlock" prompt, rather than the section disappearing outright.

14. Admin Panel — Every Module

Dashboard

Headline stats over a selectable time window, a recent-activity feed, and a single combined queue of everything needing attention: vendors awaiting approval, flagged reviews, and open disputes — each linking straight to where it's handled.

Analytics

Platform-wide performance charts and time-series data (separate from a single vendor's own analytics in §13).

Users

Every customer account — profile, quote/review history, and Ban/Unban.

Vendors

Every vendor account with full detail (quotes, ratings, catalogue, subscription). Approve / Reject / Suspend / Reinstate a vendor individually, or in bulk across many at once.

Subscriptions

Every active and past vendor subscription. Grant a plan for free (comps are excluded from revenue), or force-end a subscription immediately.

Plans

The full control panel described in §9 — pricing, limits, and every feature toggle per plan, plus a live preview of exactly what customers will see on the pricing page.

Coupons

Create, edit, deactivate, and delete discount coupons — see §11.

Categories

Manage the platform's service categories: add, edit, reorder by drag-and-drop, and delete (blocked if vendors are still assigned, unless overridden).

Reviews

Every review platform-wide, with an "All" and a "Flagged" tab. Delete any review, or dismiss a flag and restore it.

Deliveries & Disputes

The full quote/delivery pipeline across every vendor, filterable by status — including resolving open disputes (side with the vendor, or reopen it for redelivery).

Settings

Every platform-wide toggle — see §15 for the full list.

15. Platform Settings — Every Toggle

Setting	What it controls
Platform name, support email, admin email	Basic site identity.
Vendor registration	Turn off to block all new vendor signups outright.
Auto-approve vendors	On (default): new vendors go live instantly. Off: they land in the approval queue and stay hidden until an admin approves them.
Quote requests	Turn off to stop new quote requests platform-wide (existing ones are unaffected).
Reviews	Turn off to stop new reviews platform-wide (existing ones stay visible and keep counting).
Auto-complete window	How many days (1–90) a Delivered job waits for customer confirmation before auto-completing. Default 7.
Expiry reminder schedule	Which days-before-expiry a vendor gets a "your plan is ending" notification. Default: 7, 3, and 1 days before.

16. Test Credentials & Test Cards

Use these to test without needing to sign up fresh accounts each time (ask the team for current admin login details if they've changed).

Test card numbers (any future expiry date, any CVV)

Card number	Result
4111 1111 1111 1111	Always succeeds
4000 0000 0000 0002	Always declined
4000 0000 0000 0119	Pending at first, then settles successfully on a second check

No real payment is ever processed — this is a simulated gateway built specifically so the whole payment system can be tested end-to-end without a real merchant account.

17. Suggested End-to-End Test Flow

A short walkthrough that touches every core feature in one connected pass — no need to test each piece in isolation.

1. As Admin

- Log in, confirm the three plans and their prices/limits look right on the Plans page.
- Create a test coupon (e.g. 10% off, all plans).

2. As Vendor

- Sign up a new vendor account — confirm it lands on the Free plan.
- Set up the storefront: logo, description, a catalogue with a couple of items.
- Buy the Basic plan (use the always-succeeds test card), confirm the plan updates immediately and the new limits apply.
- Upgrade to Premium — confirm the checkout shows a prorated credit for unused Basic time, and apply the test coupon for an extra discount.
- Try buying Basic again while on Premium — confirm it's correctly rejected as a downgrade.

3. As Customer

- Browse to that vendor's profile and favorite it — switch to the vendor's session and confirm the notification arrives.
- Click that notification — confirm it opens directly into a chat with that customer, not just the empty inbox.
- Send a quote request to the vendor.

4. Back as Vendor

- Respond to the quote with a price, accept it, then mark it Delivered.

5. Back as Customer

- Confirm completion on the delivered job, then leave a review.

6. Back as Admin

- Confirm the new subscription, the coupon's redemption count, and the review all show up correctly.
- Force-end that vendor's subscription and confirm they drop to Free immediately with no refund shown anywhere.

18. Known Gaps & Things Intentionally Not Wired Up

Listed here so nothing below is mistaken for a bug during testing — these are known, deliberate states of the current build.

- **Vendor analytics is fully built but hidden** from the menu on purpose (§13) — not a missing feature.
- **Google/social sign-in** — the underlying fields exist in the data model, but there is no working Google login button or flow yet. Only email/password sign-in works today.
- **Password reset by email** doesn't exist yet — only "change password while logged in, with your current password" works.
- **Chat video/PDF attachments** are currently available to every vendor regardless of plan — the Premium-only restriction planned for this hasn't been switched on yet.
- **Review photos** — the system can store images on a review, but there's no upload button on the "Write a Review" form yet, so reviews are text-and-rating only in practice.
- **A vendor's category/type is fixed at signup** and can't currently be changed afterward from the storefront settings — worth keeping in mind if a tester wants to test switching categories.
- **A "Vendor Collaboration" board** exists as a working backend feature (vendors posting projects they need help with) but has no page in the app yet — not reachable or testable from the UI.
- **Admin "Disputes"** is not a separate page — it opens the Deliveries page pre-filtered to disputes, so there's exactly one place disputes are handled, not two.